SENIOR BUSINESS ANALYST · INTERVIEW PORTFOLIO

Discovery to delivery in Australian education technology

Prepared for the Education Services Australia interview panel: how 11 years of building and analysing education and training platforms maps to the Senior Business Analyst role in Strategic Partnerships and Impact.

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Introduction

ESA connects policy, technology and practice to improve education outcomes. I've spent my career in the same space from the provider side: student management, higher education enrolment, apprenticeships and group training. My work there has been to understand what users actually need, shape solutions with architects and engineers, and make sure the result holds up in delivery.

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Discovery-led

I start with the problem and the people: current-state journeys, pain points and the rules that really govern the work.

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Technically fluent

APIs, data flows, integrations and system dependencies. I work alongside architects and engineers, not just upstream of them.

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Bridging audiences

From acceptance criteria for developers to Executive Working Group reporting and client showcases.

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Quality built in

A QA background means requirements I write are testable, traceable and reviewed before they reach delivery.

Shared ground

ESA and my background serve the same sector from different sides. Much of what makes education technology hard is the same in both.

Theme	At ESA (from the position description)	In my experience
Sector	Technology-based services for the Australian education and training sector.	Student management for VET and higher education providers; apprenticeship and group training platforms.
Users	Educators, students and school communities, including diverse and underserved groups.	Students, apprentices, administrators, field officers and employers, from school leavers to adult learners.
Stakeholders	Education ministers, departments, agencies and service providers.	Providers, employers and government-contracted organisations, with government reporting and registration built into the workflow.
Constraints	Safe, effective solutions for high-visibility, nationally significant work.	Regulated workflows such as enrolment rules, government reporting, incentive claims, and security and compliance controls.

Theme	At ESA (from the position description)	In my experience
Delivery model	Business analysis as a shared service across ESA's products and departments.	Work across several products and squads, including an AI QA platform used across 24 products company-wide.
Purpose	Excellence and equity in education.	Self-service that gives students autonomy, with the institution's rules always enforced; support that keeps apprentices on track.

The role & my evidence

Each responsibility area in the position description, matched to where I've done that work.
The case-study links open the detailed walkthroughs.

Discovery & human-centred design Lead end-to-end discovery; research and synthesis; decisions traceable to users.	Led discovery across student management initiatives: current-state processes, user journeys and pain points, synthesised into future-state requirements. Mapped the higher education enrolment journey for two very different users, administrators and students. HE Enrolment Journey → · Apprentice Journey →
Solution shaping & technical engagement Work with solution and enterprise architects; feasibility; clear language for non-technical audiences.	Partnered with solution designers, architects and engineers on integrations, APIs and data flows, including a curriculum system syncing into a student management system and an assessment-results integration that removed manual matching. HE Enrolment Journey → · Project Argus →
Requirements & documentation Functional and non-functional requirements, user stories and solution approach; papers for leadership.	Wrote user stories, acceptance criteria and business rules across products. Specified a 12-control security and compliance programme, which is non-functional requirements in practice: identity, access, session, network and audit. Prepared monthly Executive Working Group reporting. Security & Compliance →
Business partnering & solutioning Proposals and tenders; strategic thinking across a suite of products; scoping sessions.	Supported initiative assessment and business cases: problem, customer impact, benefits, effort, dependencies and options. Facilitated scoping and solution-shaping workshops, and contributed to a cross-product AI platform used across ReadyTech. Project Argus →
Quality assurance & risk Peer review and stakeholder validation; raise risks with a cross-project view.	Several years as a QA engineer before moving into analysis. I review analysis artefacts for clarity and testability, maintain traceability from discovery to validation, and raise delivery risks and dependencies through governance channels. Project Argus → · Security & Compliance →
Delivery support & ways of working Clarify intent through build; model good practice; improve the team's tools.	Supported backlog refinement, ticket slicing and release planning, ran post-implementation reviews, and mentored team members. I also built reusable BA standards and templates, and AI-assisted ways of working. Self-Enrolment Demo →

Case studies

Five walkthroughs from my portfolio. Each one is also the kind of **showcase document** the advertisement asks for.

HIGHER EDUCATION

HE Enrolment Journey

Two enrolment paths, administrator-led and student self-service, on one rules engine: six validation gates, three enrolment scopes, and adjustments after enrolment.

Discovery · Journey mapping · Business rules

HIGHER EDUCATION

Student Self-Enrolment Demo

A screen-by-screen walkthrough for clients and internal teams, covering what an institution configures and what a student experiences.

Showcase document · Plain-language rules · Validation

APPRENTICESHIPS

Apprentice Journey

From jobseeker to qualified tradesperson across five parties and two platforms, with government registration in the middle and the handoffs where products can do better.

Systems thinking · Multi-stakeholder · Opportunity framing

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

Security & Compliance

Twelve configurable controls, including single sign-on, MFA, password, lockout and session policies, IP restrictions and audit logging, specified so they were buildable and testable.

Non-functional requirements · Acceptance criteria · Risk

AI & WAYS OF WORKING

Project Argus

An AI QA agent used across 24 products. I contributed to its autonomy roadmap and wrote the higher education knowledge base it tests against.

AI adoption · Shared service · Governance

How I work

My approach to a complex initiative, from a loosely defined problem to a solution the delivery team can build with confidence.

1 **Frame the problem**
Who is affected, what outcome matters and what we don't know yet. Plan the investigation before any solution work.

2 **Understand users**
Interviews, workshops and current-state observation across every user group, including those easiest to overlook.

3 **Synthesise**
Journeys, pain points and rules, made visible so stakeholders share one picture of the problem.

4 **Shape options**
With architects and engineers: feasibility, integration impact, effort and trade-offs, written up in plain language.

5 **Specify**
Functional and non-functional requirements, user stories, acceptance criteria and business rules, each traceable to evidence.

6 **Support delivery**
Clarify intent through the build, refine the backlog, and keep scope and decisions visible.

7 **Validate & learn**
UAT, release validation and post-implementation reviews, fed back into the next round of discovery.

What I bring to the role

Strengths I'd bring from the first week, and areas where I'm keen to grow with ESA.

EDUCATION SECTOR DEPTH

I already speak the language

- VET and higher education: programs, subjects, requisites, enrolment rules and census dates.
- Apprenticeships: training contracts, government registration, incentives and progress support.
- Knowledge of the regulatory and reporting obligations providers work under.

Evidence:

HE & apprenticeship case studies

TECHNICAL DEPTH

A credible partner for architects

- Integration analysis: APIs, data flows, sync between systems and upstream and downstream dependencies.
- Hands-on with SQL, testing and automation, so I understand what makes a requirement deliverable.
- Practical AI experience: an AI agent used across 24 products, with governance designed in.

Evidence: Project Argus Integrations

WHERE I'LL LEAN IN

Growing with the practice

- **Equity-centred and co-design methods:** I design for diverse users today, and want to formalise it with ESA's practice.
- **Tenders and proposals:** I've built business cases and option analyses, and I'm keen to apply that under tender timeframes.
- **Shared-service BA:** I'd bring my cross-product experience and adapt to ESA's model.

Approach:

Learn the model, then contribute

13+	11	4	5
years in IT	years in education & training technology	perspectives: QA, BA, product owner, delivery lead	showcase case studies

My first 90 days

How I'd approach starting in the team. It's a starting point to discuss, not a fixed plan.

FIRST 30 DAYS

Listen & learn

- Meet the BA practice, UX, architects and program leads.
- Learn ESA's products, stakeholders and shared-service model.
- Shadow live discovery and review the practice's templates.

DAYS 30 – 60

Contribute

- Take on discovery or requirements on an active initiative.
- Peer-review the team's outputs, and invite review of mine.
- Support a proposal or business case alongside the team.

DAYS 60 – 90

Strengthen

- Lead discovery on a defined piece of work end to end.
- Share what's worked for me: journey mapping, traceability and AI-assisted analysis.
- Agree development goals, such as CBAP and co-design practice.

🎯 **In one line:** I bring education-sector depth, technical credibility and a quality mindset to discovery, and I'm ready to apply them to work that matters nationally.